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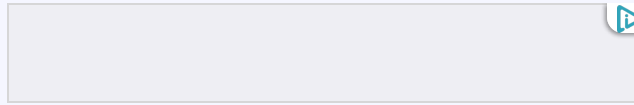
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Capital Cities: Unabashedly Cheery

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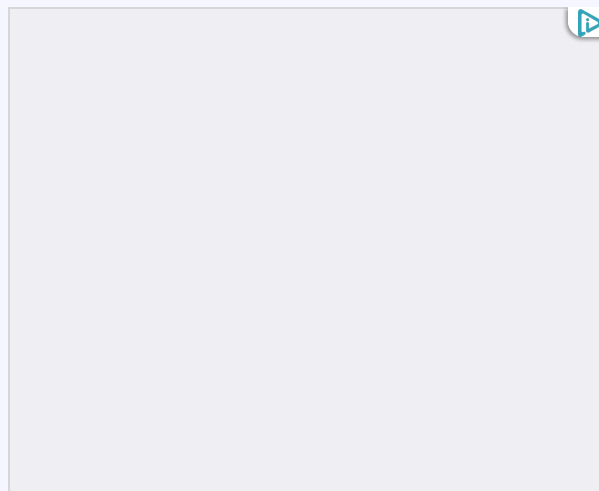
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In town for a series of shows, The LA-based indie pop duo explains why their debut album is bursting with optimism and where they got their sweet moves

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MANILA, Philippines – There’s a blazing fire of youthful optimism that runs through all 12 tracks of Capital Cities’ debut album *In A Tidal Wave of Mystery*. It’s sugary sweet – for some, almost cavity-inducing.

In their international hit “Safe and Sound,” a blaring trumpet and old-school electronic synth samples usher in the verse, “I could lift you up / I could show you what you wanna see / And take you where you wanna be//.” In “Farrah Fawcett Hair” they gush about all the beautiful things in the world including, but not limited to, solar energy, Nutella, bathrooms with scented candles, and of course, Farrah Fawcett’s actual hair.

It’s all so random and ordinary, and at the same time, so catchy and effervescent. And that’s exactly the way Ryan Merchant and Sebu Simonian, the duo behind the Los Angeles-based indie electro pop group, want it.

“Optimism is a key word, I think, at least when it comes to the message of our music,” explains Sebu, who, together with Merchant and their band, arrived in the Manila last January 10 for a series of performances sponsored by Ayala Malls.

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...sale and sound, the first single on their debut album, topped several music charts around the world and became an Internet sensation. Its music video won the Best in Visual Effects prize at the 2013 MTV Video Music Awards.

“We don’t think about it consciously,” explains Ryan on the infectious nature of their songwriting. “Even though we were jingle writers for two and a half years, we both started writing music for bands. So first and foremost, we’re singer-songwriters for artistic band projects and the jingle writing thing was something that we kind of fell into.”

He adds, “I think we both had a knack for it because we’re both obsessed with writing interesting melodies. I think jingle writing is very much about coming up with catchy

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